MBA666: Project Management

Low Code/No Code

The New Era of Project Management

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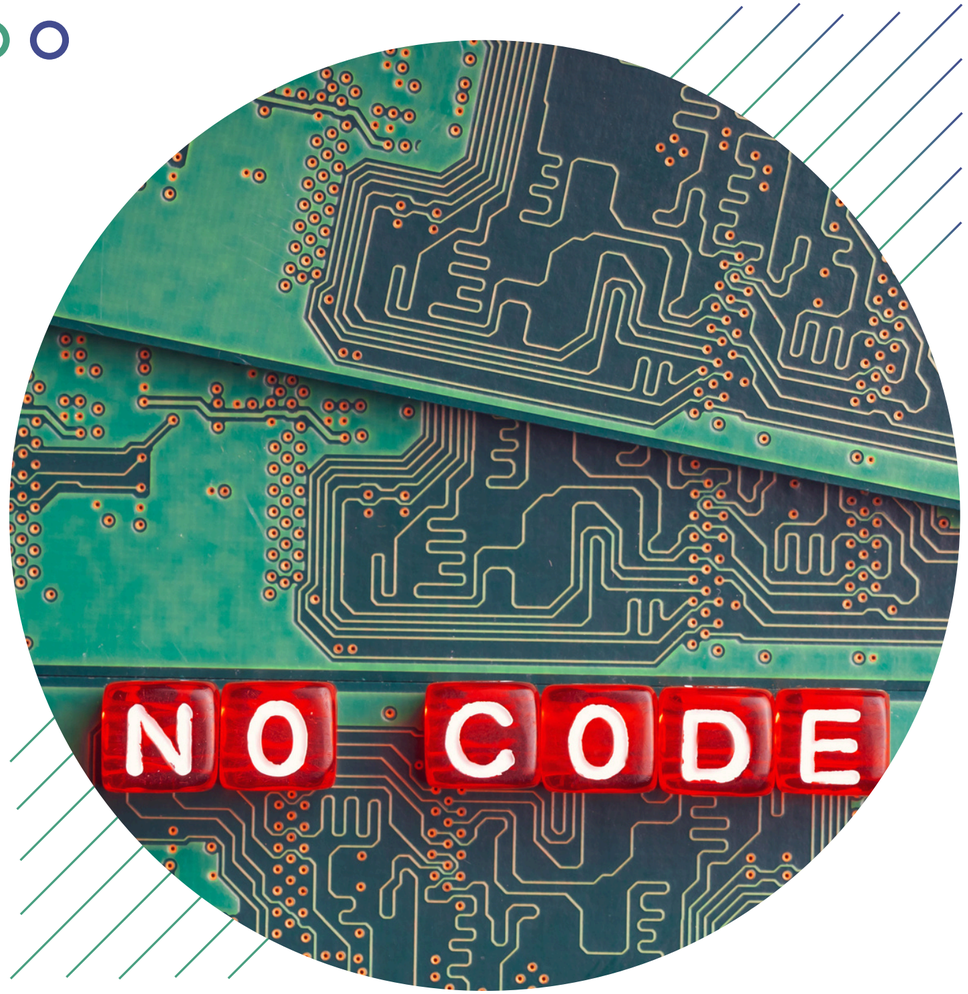

Introduction

Traditional Landscape

- Traditional software development depended on manual coding — writing each line from scratch.
- Provided maximum customization and control over the product.
- Required highly specialized skills, significant time, and substantial costs.
- Faced challenges like:
  - Project delays
  - Changing requirements
  - Shortage of skilled developers
- Made it difficult to quickly adapt to business needs.

Low Code Platforms

- Low-code platforms simplify software development using visual, drag-and-drop tools.
- Allow flexibility.
- Enable professional developers and tech-savvy project managers to build applications faster.
- Support creation of complex, enterprise-grade solutions.
- Promote reuse of pre-built components, reducing development time.
- Examples: Microsoft Power Apps, Mendix.

No Code Platforms

- No-code platforms take simplification further with fully pre-assembled, drag-and-drop tools.
- Requires zero coding knowledge.
- Use visual interfaces to let users build apps by combining pre-built elements.
- Enable quick creation of simple workflows, dashboards, and automations.
- Eliminate the need for programming expertise.
- Popular examples: Airtable, Bubble

LCNC Integration Across the Project Life Cycle

Initiation → *Planning* → *Execution* → *Monitoring & Controlling* → *Closure*

Overview

- Performs preliminary analysis and prepares a business case for evaluation.
- Includes stakeholder identification and initial risk assessment.
- Defines the strategic need, objectives, and feasibility of the project.
- Conducts problem or opportunity identification to justify project initiation.

How LCNC Platforms Enhance the Project Initiation Phase

- **Rapid Prototyping and Proof of Concept:** LCNC platforms allow project managers to quickly create working prototypes or proof-of-concept demonstrations without extensive development resources. This helps stakeholders visualize the end product early and validate project feasibility before committing significant resources.

- **Stakeholder Requirement Gathering:** Project managers can use LCNC tools to build interactive mockups during requirement gathering sessions, enabling stakeholders to see and interact with potential solutions in real-time. This leads to more accurate requirements and reduces misunderstandings about project scope.

- **Project Charter Development:** LCNC platforms can support creating collaborative project charter documents, dashboards, or simple workflows that help define project objectives, success criteria, and high-level scope in an engaging, visual format that's easier for stakeholders to understand and approve.

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How LCNC Platforms Enhance the Project Initiation Phase

- **Structured Stakeholder Input Collection:** Instead of traditional note-taking, project managers can deploy no-code forms (Google Forms, Airtable, Typeform) to systematically gather stakeholder ideas and requirements. This creates a structured, sortable database from day one, ensuring no input is lost.

- **Visual Requirement Management:** Platforms like Trello, Monday.com, or Notion allow project managers to operate in "brainstorming mode" where requirements, features, and ideas become visual cards that can be organized, prioritized, and categorized collaboratively.

LCNC Integration Across the Project Life Cycle

Initiation | ***Planning*** | *Execution* | *Monitoring & Controlling* | *Closure*

Overview

- Translate objectives into detailed tasks and deliverables.
- Define scope, schedule, resources, and cost baselines.
- Create work breakdown structures and task dependencies.
- Develop risk management, communication, and quality plans.
- Assign roles and responsibilities to team members.
- Finalize performance metrics and approval workflows.
- Set clear performance baselines (time, cost, quality).

How LCNC Platforms Enhance the Project Planning Phase

- **Visual Workflow Mapping:** Create Kanban boards or Gantt charts using drag-and-drop functionality to map out project dependencies, identify potential bottlenecks, and visualize the entire workflow without coding.

- **Detailed Task Breakdown:** Use drag-and-drop tools to create detailed task breakdowns with clear deadlines, breaking down complex projects into manageable components.

- **Budget Tracking:** Leverage built-in budget tracking to allocate resources efficiently and monitor spending throughout the project lifecycle.

- **Automated Scheduling:** Take advantage of automated scheduling features to assign tasks, set reminders, and manage dependencies between team members, ensuring everyone knows their deliverables and deadlines.

LCNC Integration Across the Project Life Cycle

Initiation → *Planning* → ***Execution*** → *Monitoring & Controlling* → *Closure*

Overview

- Launch and implement the project plan.
- Coordinate teams and manage day-to-day execution.
- Communicate and collaborate across stakeholders.
- Manage deliverables, timelines, and quality outputs.
- Handle issues and process change requests as needed.
- Ensure alignment with objectives and client expectations.

How LCNC Platforms Enhance the Project Execution Phase

- **Automated Task Management:** Define workflows and automate task creation and assignment based on predefined rules, ensuring everyone understands their responsibilities without manual intervention.

- **Real-Time Progress Tracking:** Use real-time progress-tracking dashboards where team members update tasks, upload deliverables, and collaborate seamlessly—eliminating the need for endless status update meetings.

- **Integrated Collaboration Tools:** Break down communication silos using built-in chat features, document collaboration tools, and discussion forums for real-time communication and issue troubleshooting.

- **Process Automation:** Automate many daily tasks such as resource management, timekeeping, and project progress tracking, allowing project managers to focus on more strategic aspects of work.

LCNC Integration Across the Project Life Cycle

Initiation → *Planning* → *Execution* → ***Monitoring & Controlling*** → *Closure*

Overview

- Track and measure performance against baselines using:
  - KPIs (Key Performance Indicators)
  - Risk assessments
  - Earned Value Analysis (EVA)
- Implement corrective actions to address deviations from the plan.
- Apply preventive measures to avoid potential issues.
- Ensure the project remains aligned with objectives and timelines.

How LCNC Platforms Enhance the Project Monitoring & Controlling Phase

- **Customizable Real-Time Dashboards:** Gain instant insights into project with dashboards that track key metrics like task completion rates, budget adherence, and resource utilization in a single, centralized location.

- **Automated Milestone Alerts:** Set up automated alerts to notify stakeholders of upcoming milestones, missed deadlines, resource overheads, or key project events, ensuring proactive adjustments.

- **Risk Management:** Document potential risks, assess their impact, and develop mitigation strategies using built-in risk management tools, enabling early identification of roadblocks.

- **Automated Reporting:** Generate real-time reports effortlessly and share project progress with stakeholders, keeping everyone informed and aligned without manual report creation.

LCNC Integration Across the Project Life Cycle

Initiation → *Planning* → *Execution* → *Monitoring & Controlling* → ***Closure***

Overview

- Formally complete project activities by:
  - Obtaining stakeholder acceptance
  - Finalizing deliverables
  - Releasing project resources
- Document lessons learned for future reference.
- Archive project records systematically.
- Ensure knowledge transfer to support organizational learning.

How LCNC Platforms Enhance the Project Closure Phase

- **Centralized Document Management:** Consolidate all project documents, presentations, and final deliverables within the platform, making everything easily accessible for future reference and eliminating scattered files.

- **Built-in Feedback Surveys:** Gather feedback from stakeholders and team members directly within the platform using built-in survey features, simplifying the post-project review process.

- **Automated Archiving:** Leverage archiving capabilities to store project data securely and organize it for easy retrieval, fostering knowledge retention and enabling smoother handovers for future projects.

LCNC Platforms Landscape

Sn. No.	Platform	Type	Best for	Key Features
1	Monday.com	No-Code	Visual project tracking	• Customizable workflows & dashboards • Timeline, Gantt, and Kanban views • Task automation & notifications • Team collaboration with integrations (Slack, Jira)
2	Airtable	No-Code	Flexible databases for projects	• Spreadsheet–database hybrid • Relational tables for project data • Powerful filters, views & grouping • Real-time collaboration & automation
3	Microsoft Power Apps	Low-Code	Enterprise integration & PM solutions	• Deep integration with Microsoft 365 & Teams • Automate workflows via Power Automate • Custom PM apps with minimal coding • Data insights through Power BI
4	Smartsheet	Low-Code	Portfolio & resource management	• Gantt charts & critical path tracking • Resource allocation & workload view • Automated alerts & approval workflows • Portfolio-level visibility & reporting
5	ClickUp	No-Code	All-in-one project management hub	• Tasks, docs, goals, time tracking • Multi-view support (List, Board, Gantt) • Custom fields & recurring tasks • Integrations with Google Drive, Slack, etc
6	Notion	No-Code	Knowledge + project management	• Unified workspace for docs & tasks • Templates for project timelines & OKRs • Real-time collaboration & databases • Integration with calendars & tools (Trello, Asana)

LCNC Platforms Landscape

Robust Low-Code and No-Code (LCNC) platforms share several essential features that enable businesses to accelerate development, improve flexibility, and ensure scalability and security. Some of the majorly used platforms include:

Categorisation of platforms by their use in Project Management

Category	Platforms	Used for
Task & Workflow Management	Monday.com, ClickUp	Daily task tracking, Gantt charts, automation
Database & Resource Planning	Airtable, Smartsheet	Centralized project data, resource allocation
Enterprise & Process Integration	Power Apps	Custom enterprise workflows, integration with Microsoft systems
Knowledge & Collaboration	Notion	Internal documentation, collaborative planning

Monday.com

ClickUp

Airtable

Smartsheet

Microsoft power apps

Notion

Industry-Wise Use Cases

01

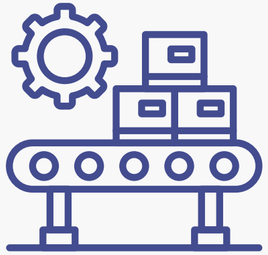
IT & SOFTWARE

How LCNC Tools are used?
Managing agile sprints, assigning tasks, automating bug tracking, integrating CI/CD updates into dashboards
Example Platforms: Monday.com, ClickUp, Microsoft power Apps, Retool

02

MANUFACTURING

How LCNC Tools are used?
Tracking production timelines, managing maintenance projects, monitoring resource utilization and downtime
Example Platforms: Smartsheet, Airtable, Quickbase, Zoho Creator



03

HEALTHCARE

How LCNC Tools are used?
Coordinating clinical projects, managing patient-care workflows, tracking compliance tasks and reports
Example Platforms: Kissflow, Appian, Microsoft power Apps, Quickbase

04

CONSTRUCTION

How LCNC Tools are used?
Tracking site progress, managing contractor tasks, scheduling resources and safety check projects
Example Platforms: Smartsheet, Microsoft Power apps, Quickbase,Zoho Creator

05

FINANCE & BANKING

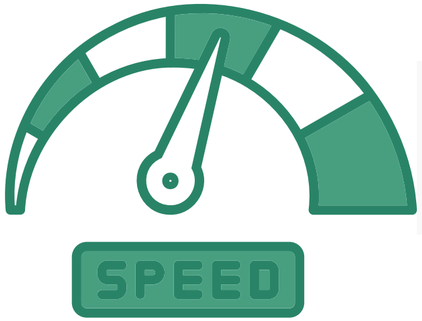
How LCNC Tools are used?
Overseeing automation projects, tracking regulatory audit deliverables, visualizing project risk and status
Example Platforms: OutSystems, Quickbase, Microsoft power Apps

06

MARKETING & MEDIA

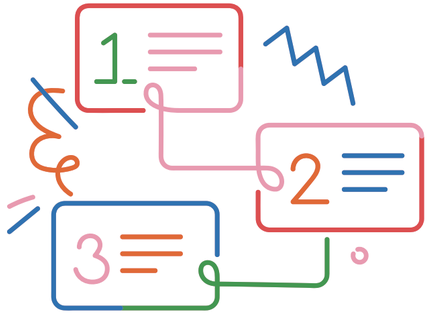
How LCNC Tools are used?
Managing campaign timelines, creative asset approval workflows, cross-team progress tracking
Example Platforms: Quickbase, Smartsheet, Microsoft power Apps

Benefits of LCNC for Project Managers and Teams

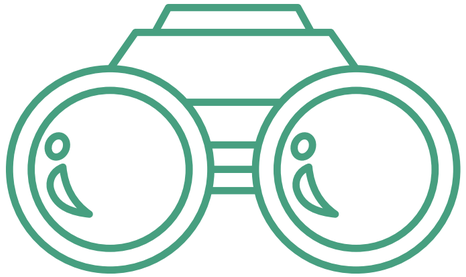


01 LCNC tools provide speed, flexibility, and collaboration advantages.

04 Reduces dependency on IT for every small modification or report.



02 Project managers can prototype, test, and iterate solutions without long development cycles.



03 Teams gain visibility, automation, and improved communication.

05 Aligns with Agile and iterative project management methodologies.

Challenges and Risk Mitigation for LCNC Adoption in PM

Challenges

- Integration complexity
- Governance and security
- User adoption issues
- Training needs
- Scalability limitations

Risks

- Clear Governance Policies
- Standardization of Templates
- Change Management
- IT and PMO Collaboration
- Regular Security Audits

Case Studies : Microsoft Power BI

A global consulting firm used to rely on manual spreadsheets and email updates for project tracking. This caused :

1. weekly delays
2. manual errors
3. Inconsistent reporting formats
4. Need to search for information

After the application of the Power BI Dashboard in the project:

- Before: each Project Manager (PM) spent **5 hours/week** preparing and consolidating project status, risks, and reports (manual data pulls + formatting).
- After LCNC (Power Apps + automated data feeds): reporting reduced to **0.5 hours/week** per PM.
- Also, as the format is standardized now, the other team member can also pull the data and send the update in the absence of the PM.
- Benefits:
  - Huge reduction in PM reporting overhead (90%).
  - Freed capacity equivalent to ~5.6 full-time staff that can be reallocated to delivery or strategic tasks.
  - Direct labor cost saving.

Case Studies : Microsoft Power BI

Assumptions

- Number of PMs = 50.
- Work weeks/year = 52.
- 1 FTE = 2080 hours/year (52*5*8).
- Average PM hourly cost = Rs 1200/hr (approx) Considering salary 25L

Calculations

- Time saved per PM per week = 5.0 - 0.5 = 4.5 hours/week.
- Total saved hours/week (50 PMs) = 4.5 * 50 = 225 hours/week.
- Total saved hours/year = 225 * 52 = 11,700 hours/year.
- FTEs recovered = 11,700 / 2,080 = 5.625 FTEs.
- Time reduction per PM = (4.5 / 5.0) * 100 = 90% reduction in reporting time.
- Annual cost savings = 11,700 * 1200 = Rs 1,40,40,000/year.

Note: FTE: Full-Time Equivalent*

before

after

Metric	Before LCNC Implementation	After Power Apps Implementation	Improvement
Reporting time per PM (weekly)	5 hours	0.5 hours	90% reduction
Total PMs	50	50	
Total hours spent per week	250 hours	25 hours	225 hours saved
Total hours saved per year	–	11,700 hours	5.6 FTEs
Approx. cost saving (at Rs 1200/hr)	–	Rs 1,40,40,000 annually	

Case Studies: Canva

A normal student mostly relies on PowerPoint presentations for presenting the ideas in the form of visuals:

1. Long Working Hours
2. Manual Saving and Hardware Dependancy
3. Limited options and visuals
4. Require high efforts

After the application of Canva in the project:

- Before: each student (PM) spent approximately 20 **hours/week** preparing and consolidating, and creating projects and reports (manual data pulls + formatting).
- After LCNC (Canva + data feeds options): Preparation time reduced to 5 **hours/week** per (Student) PM.
- Also, with the highly graphic animations, images, and templates available now, the options and varieties are wide and create a more effective presentation easily.
- Benefits:
  - Huge reduction in efforts (75%).
  - Freed capacity equivalent to 15 full-time hours that can be reallocated to deliver some other tasks.
  - Direct time saving

Case Studies: Canva

Assumptions

- Number of Students = 50.
- Work weeks/year = 40.
- 1 FTE = 1600 hours/year (40*5*8).

Calculations

- Time saved per PM per week = 20 - 5 = 15 hours/week.
- Total saved hours/week (50 PMs) = 15 * 50 = 750 hours/week.
- Total saved hours/year = 750 * 40 = 30,000 hours/year.
- FTEs recovered = 30,000 / 1,600 = 18.75 FTEs.
- Time reduction per PM = (15 / 20) × 100 = 75% reduction in efforts.
- Annual cost savings = Extra time to invest in some other activity.

Note: FTE: Full-Time Equivalent*

before

after

Metric	Before LCNC Implementation	After Power Apps Implementation	Improvement
Reporting time per PM (weekly)	20 hours	5 hours	75% reduction
Total PMs (Students)	50	50	
Total hours spent per week	1000 hours	250 hours	750 hours saved
Total hours saved per year	–	30,000 hours	18.75 FTEs

Evolution of the Project Manager's Role in the LCNC Era

01. From Administrator To Strategic Leader

- **Past:** PMs spent over 50% of their time tracking progress, updating spreadsheets, managing reports.
- **Now:** Automation tools (e.g., Power Automate, Smartsheet) generate live dashboards: freeing PMs to focus on strategic planning, stakeholder alignment, and business impact.
- **Impact:** PMs act as decision enablers rather than task trackers.

02. From Manual To Automated Workflows

- **Past:** Gathering data from multiple sources, consolidating manually, and updating reports weekly.
- **Now:** LCNC platforms automate status updates, approvals, alerts, and resource tracking in real time.
- **Impact:** Saves hours of repetitive work, improves accuracy, and gives a single source of truth for all teams.

03. From Reactive To Proactive Management

- **Past:** PMs could only respond after risks or delays occurred.
- **Now:** Data analytics and AI-driven insights from LCNC dashboards help predict delays, budget overruns, and workload bottlenecks early.
- **Impact:** Enables preventive planning and better project resilience

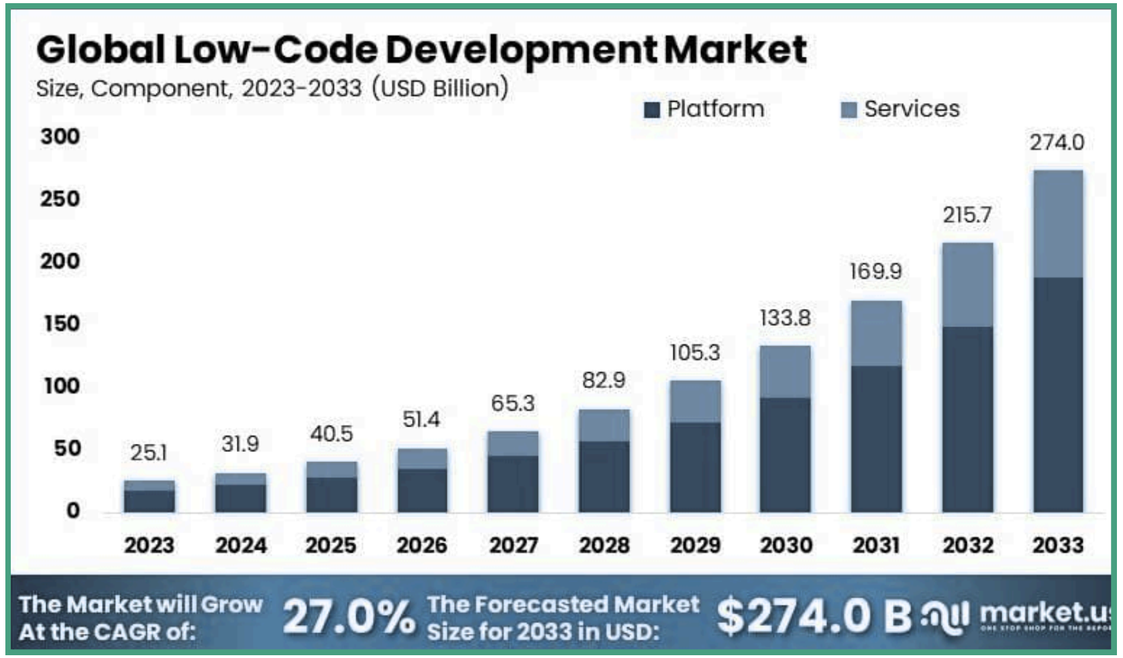
04. From Task Manager To Team Coach

- **Past:** PMs focused on assigning and monitoring tasks.
- **Now:** With automation handling task tracking, PMs invest more time in mentoring, cross-functional collaboration, and culture building.
- **Impact:** Increases team engagement, innovation, and productivity.

Future Trends in LC/NC for Project Management

Market Growth Trajectory

- The global LC/NC market is projected to grow from USD 25.1 B in 2023 to USD 274 B by 2033. This represents a CAGR of 27 % over the decade.
- Growth is driven by both platform expansion and services integration, with platforms forming the largest share.
- Adoption is expected to accelerate sharply after 2026, aligning with enterprise-wide digital transformation strategies.



Leading LC/NC vendors like Microsoft, OutSystems, Mendix, and Salesforce reflect the market's growing maturity and enterprise trust. A strong shift toward AI integration, extensibility, and orchestration is emerging, while niche players continue to innovate on developer experience and citizen development.

Future Trends in LC/NC for Project Management

AI Integration Trend

- **The AI Readiness Gap:** Globally, AI maturity remains uneven, with 75 % of North American, 66 % of African, and 63 % of Latin American organizations reporting low levels of AI readiness. Only 59 % of North American organizations are actively building AI competence, compared to just 30 % in Latin America, highlighting a significant skills gap between regions. This disparity reflects how AI adoption is still concentrated in a few advanced markets, leaving many organizations without the expertise or resources to scale effectively.
- **LC/NC as the Bridge:** Low-code/no-code (LC/NC) platforms can play a critical role in bridging this gap by providing accessible, user-friendly tools that enable teams to leverage AI without requiring deep technical expertise. By lowering barriers to entry, LC/NC accelerates digital transformation, promotes inclusive innovation, and allows organizations in emerging economies to actively participate in the global AI shift. For project management offices, this positions LC/NC as a strategic lever to close capability gaps, standardize delivery, and accelerate transformation across diverse maturity levels.

Mobility-First Project Environments

- With 65 % of LC/NC users relying on mobile interfaces, project execution is moving beyond the desktop. Mobile apps with offline-first features and real-time dashboards will accelerate inspections, approvals, and reporting, especially in logistics, infrastructure, and manufacturing.

Rise of Citizen Developers

- Organizations will increasingly leverage business users—rather than only IT teams—to build solutions. This democratization will speed up delivery cycles, expand capacity, and reduce the burden on centralized tech resources.

Platform Convergence

- ·We may see more all-in-one platforms. Monday.com is moving toward full app building; Airtable and others keep adding features like automations and scripts. Eventually, the line between “specialized project tool” and “LC/NC platform” will blur. This could simplify tool selection: one platform for planning, tracking, and basic automation.

Group Number 2

THANK YOU

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